PARTICIPATORY GOVERNANCE

PARTICIPATION LADDER → THE INDIAN PARTICIPATION PARADOX → CONSULTATION POLICY STATUS CARD → NAMED PARTICIPATION FORUMS → WHY DECISIONS DRIFT UPWARD → TWO SEPARATIONS INSIDE ONE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

PARTICIPATION LADDER

PARTICIPATION LADDER · TOLD AFTER THE DECISION; SCHEME PUBLICITY AND PROACTIVE DISCLOSURE · ASKED, DECISION-MAKER NOT BOUND; 2014 POLICY AND THE ENGAGEMENT · TAKE PART IN PLANNING; VILLAGE ASSEMBLY IN PLAN APPROVAL · DETERMINE AN OUTCOME; PARTICIPATORY BUDGETING; ASSEMBLY APPROVAL UNDER PESA · PRODUCE THE OUTCOME JOINTLY; COMMUNITY MONITORING, USER GROUPS, SOCIAL · DELEGATED CONTROL · RUN THE SERVICE; COMMUNITY-MANAGED SCHEMES WITH THEIR OWN ACCOUNTABILITY

INFORMATION → told after the decision; scheme publicity and proactive disclosure; not participation

CONSULTATION → asked, decision-maker not bound; 2014 policy and the engagement platform → INVOLVEMENT → take part in planning; village assembly in plan approval; ward meetings → CO-DECISION → determine an outcome; participatory budgeting; assembly approval under PESA

CORE CLAIM

- INFORMATION → told after the decision; scheme publicity and proactive disclosure; not participation
- CONSULTATION → asked, decision-maker not bound; 2014 policy and the engagement platform
- INVOLVEMENT → take part in planning; village assembly in plan approval; ward meetings

MECHANISM

- CO-DECISION → determine an outcome; participatory budgeting; assembly approval under PESA
- CO-PRODUCTION → produce the outcome jointly; community monitoring, user groups, social audit
- DELEGATED CONTROL → run the service; community-managed schemes with their own accountability

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MUST REMEMBER: Participatory governance distributes voice across information,...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Participatory governance distributes voice across information,.

01

STAGE 01

THE INDIAN PARTICIPATION PARADOX

THE INDIAN PARTICIPATION PARADOX · MOST INSTITUTIONALISED · PRE-LEGISLATIVE CONSULTATION AND THE CITIZEN-ENGAGEMENT PLATFORM · THEIR RUNG · CONSULTATION, THE WEAKEST RUNG ABOVE BEING MERELY INFORMED · MOST CO-DECISIONAL · PARTICIPATORY BUDGETING OVER A DEFINED SHARE OF A MUNICIPAL · ITS SCALE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
MOST INSTITUTIONALISED → pre-legislative consultation and the citizen-engagement platform	MOST CO-DECISIONAL → participatory budgeting over a defined share of a municipal budget	FINDING → the forms of participation are institutionalised and the substance is not
THEIR RUNG → consultation, the weakest rung above being merely informed	ITS SCALE → scattered municipal and ward pilots rather than a universal practice	MOST INSTITUTIONALISED → pre-legislative consultation and the citizen-engagement platform

CORE CLAIM

- MOST INSTITUTIONALISED → pre-legislative consultation and the citizen-engagement platform
- THEIR RUNG → consultation, the weakest rung above being merely informed

MECHANISM

- MOST CO-DECISIONAL → participatory budgeting over a defined share of a municipal budget
- ITS SCALE → scattered municipal and ward pilots rather than a universal practice

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- FINDING → the forms of participation are institutionalised and the substance is not
- MOST INSTITUTIONALISED → pre-legislative consultation and the citizen-engagement platform

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FINDING → the forms of participation are institutionalised and the substance is not.

02

STAGE 02

CONSULTATION POLICY STATUS CARD

CONSULTATION POLICY STATUS CARD · PRE-LEGISLATIVE CONSULTATION POLICY, 2014 · PUBLISH THE DRAFT WITH EXPLANATORY MATERIAL; ORDINARILY AT LEAST · STATED EXCEPTIONS APPLY AND THE WINDOW MAY BE CURTAILED · EXECUTIVE POLICY, NOT A STATUTE; COMMENTS ARE NOT BINDING · NO GENERAL DUTY TO PUBLISH A REASONED RESPONSE TO

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
INSTRUMENT → Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014	EXCEPTIONS → stated exceptions apply and the window may be curtailed	GAP → no general duty to publish a reasoned response to objections
CONTENT → publish the draft with explanatory material; ordinarily at least thirty days	STATUS → executive policy, not a statute; comments are not binding	INSTRUMENT → Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014

CORE CLAIM

- INSTRUMENT → Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014
- CONTENT → publish the draft with explanatory material; ordinarily at least thirty days

MECHANISM

- EXCEPTIONS → stated exceptions apply and the window may be curtailed
- STATUS → executive policy, not a statute; comments are not binding

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- GAP → no general duty to publish a reasoned response to objections
- INSTRUMENT → Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GAP → no general duty to publish a reasoned response to objections.

03

STAGE 03

NAMED PARTICIPATION FORUMS

NAMED PARTICIPATION FORUMS · VILLAGE ASSEMBLY · ALL REGISTERED VOTERS IN A PANCHAYAT AREA; TEST · WHAT CAN IT DECIDE · WARD COMMITTEE · ARTICLE 243S; MUNICIPALITIES OF THREE LAKH OR MORE; STATE · PARTICIPATORY BUDGETING · CO-DECISION OVER A DEFINED BUDGET SHARE; PILOT-SCALE IN INDIA

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
VILLAGE ASSEMBLY → all registered voters in a Panchayat area; test: what can it decide	PARTICIPATORY BUDGETING → co-decision over a defined budget share; pilot-scale in India	VILLAGE ASSEMBLY → all registered voters in a Panchayat area; test: what can it decide
WARD COMMITTEE → Article 243S; municipalities of three lakh or more; State law on composition	SCHEDULED AREAS → PESA assembly powers; consultation before acquisition, not consent	WARD COMMITTEE → Article 243S; municipalities of three lakh or more; State law on composition

CORE CLAIM

- VILLAGE ASSEMBLY → all registered voters in a Panchayat area; test: what can it decide
- WARD COMMITTEE → Article 243S; municipalities of three lakh or more; State law on composition

MECHANISM

- PARTICIPATORY BUDGETING → co-decision over a defined budget share; pilot-scale in India
- SCHEDULED AREAS → PESA assembly powers; consultation before acquisition, not consent

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- VILLAGE ASSEMBLY → all registered voters in a Panchayat area; test: what can it decide
- WARD COMMITTEE → Article 243S; municipalities of three lakh or more; State law on composition

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SCHEDULED AREAS → PESA assembly powers; consultation before acquisition, not consent.

04

STAGE 04

WHY DECISIONS DRIFT UPWARD

WHY DECISIONS DRIFT UPWARD · ADMINISTRATIVE CONVENIENCE · ONE DESIGN IS SIMPLER TO RUN THAN HUNDREDS OF · CAPACITY ARGUMENT · GENUINE AND SELF-FULFILLING WHERE AUTHORITY IS NEVER GIVEN · POLITICAL-CONTROL INCENTIVE · DISCRETIONARY ALLOCATION CARRIES POLITICAL CREDIT · INFORMATION LOSS

ADMINISTRATIVE CONVENIENCE → one design is simpler to run than hundreds of local variants → CAPACITY ARGUMENT: genuine and self-fulfilling where authority is never given → POLITICAL-CONTROL INCENTIVE: discretionary allocation carries political credit → INFORMATION LOSS: local report to block to district to State to Union, filtered each step → DECISION WITHOUT CURRENT LOCAL INFORMATION

CORE CLAIM

- ADMINISTRATIVE CONVENIENCE → one design is simpler to run than hundreds of local variants
- CAPACITY ARGUMENT: genuine and self-fulfilling where authority is never given

MECHANISM

- POLITICAL-CONTROL INCENTIVE: discretionary allocation carries political credit
- INFORMATION LOSS: local report to block to district to State to Union, filtered each step

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- DECISION WITHOUT CURRENT LOCAL INFORMATION
- OUTCOME MISMATCH: wrong design, wrong sequence or arriving too late to be useful

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OUTCOME MISMATCH: wrong design, wrong sequence or arriving too late to be useful.

05

STAGE 05

TWO SEPARATIONS INSIDE ONE DEMAND

TWO SEPARATIONS INSIDE ONE DEMAND · SEPARATION FROM INFORMATION · THE DECISION-MAKER LACKS ACCURATE, CURRENT LOCAL KNOWLEDGE · SEPARATION FROM EXECUTION · THE DECISION-MAKER LACKS AWARENESS OF AND ACCOUNTABILITY FOR DELIVERY · WHY IT MATTERS · EACH HAS A DIFFERENT CORRECTIVE AND MERGING THEM LOSES · FIX FOR THE FIRST

SEPARATION FROM INFORMATION → the decision-maker lacks accurate, current local knowledge → SEPARATION FROM EXECUTION → the decision-maker lacks awareness of and accountability for delivery → WHY IT MATTERS → each has a different corrective and merging them loses the analytical → FIX FOR THE FIRST → relocate priority-setting; FIX FOR THE SECOND → relocate answerability → CLOSE DISTINCTION: Attendance is not participation, consultation is not consent, public

CORE CLAIM

- SEPARATION FROM INFORMATION → the decision-maker lacks accurate, current local knowledge
- SEPARATION FROM EXECUTION → the decision-maker lacks awareness of and accountability for delivery

MECHANISM

- WHY IT MATTERS → each has a different corrective and merging them loses the analytical mark
- FIX FOR THE FIRST → relocate priority-setting; FIX FOR THE SECOND → relocate answerability

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Attendance is not participation, consultation is not consent, public...
- SEPARATION FROM INFORMATION → the decision-maker lacks accurate, current local knowledge

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Attendance is not participation, consultation is not consent, public.

06

STAGE 06

COUNTERWEIGHT CARD

COUNTERWEIGHT CARD · LEGITIMATE CENTRALISATION · SCALE IN LARGE INFRASTRUCTURE; INTER-REGIONAL EQUITY · SPECIALISED TECHNICAL CAPACITY; RIGHTS THAT MUST NOT VARY LOCALLY · ELITE CAPTURE · A LOCAL FORUM CAN REFLECT A DOMINANT CASTE OR · CAPTURE SAFEGUARDS · RESERVATION, ROTATION, FACILITATION, DISCLOSURE, QUORUM, SOCIAL AUDIT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
LEGITIMATE CENTRALISATION → scale in large infrastructure; inter-regional equity	ELITE CAPTURE → a local forum can reflect a dominant caste or economic group	LEGITIMATE CENTRALISATION → scale in large infrastructure; inter-regional equity
LEGITIMATE CENTRALISATION → specialised technical capacity; rights that must not vary locally	CAPTURE SAFEGUARDS → reservation, rotation, facilitation, disclosure, quorum, social audit	LEGITIMATE CENTRALISATION → specialised technical capacity; rights that must not vary locally

CORE CLAIM

- LEGITIMATE CENTRALISATION → scale in large infrastructure; inter-regional equity
- LEGITIMATE CENTRALISATION → specialised technical capacity; rights that must not vary locally

MECHANISM

- ELITE CAPTURE → a local forum can reflect a dominant caste or economic group
- CAPTURE SAFEGUARDS → reservation, rotation, facilitation, disclosure, quorum, social audit

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- LEGITIMATE CENTRALISATION → scale in large infrastructure; inter-regional equity
- LEGITIMATE CENTRALISATION → specialised technical capacity; rights that must not vary locally

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAPTURE SAFEGUARDS → reservation, rotation, facilitation, disclosure, quorum, social audit.

07

STAGE 07

EIGHT DELIBERATION DESIGN TESTS

EIGHT DELIBERATION DESIGN TESTS · 1 AUTHORITY · IS THE FORUM DECIDING, OR ADVISING ON A DECISION · 2 TIMING · IS IT CONSULTED BEFORE THE OPTIONS ARE FORECLOSED · 3 INFORMATION · BUDGET, OPTIONS AND TRADE-OFFS IN USABLE FORM AND LANGUAGE · 4 INCLUSION

1 AUTHORITY → is the forum deciding, or advising on a decision already taken → 2 TIMING → is it consulted before the options are foreclosed → 3 INFORMATION → budget, options and trade-offs in usable form and language → 4 INCLUSION → who is absent: women, landless, migrants, disabled persons, the poorest → 5 FACILITATION → independent facilitator, or the implementing agency running its own hearing

CORE CLAIM

- 1 AUTHORITY → is the forum deciding, or advising on a decision already taken
- 2 TIMING → is it consulted before the options are foreclosed
- 3 INFORMATION → budget, options and trade-offs in usable form and language

MECHANISM

- 4 INCLUSION → who is absent: women, landless, migrants, disabled persons, the poorest
- 5 FACILITATION → independent facilitator, or the implementing agency running its own hearing
- 6 RECORD AND RESPONSE → objections recorded and a reasoned response published

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 7 FEEDBACK LOOP → does the participant learn what happened to the input
- 8 IN CONFLICT → recognised representatives, agreed facts and a route to a binding outcome

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 8 IN CONFLICT → recognised representatives, agreed facts and a route to a binding outcome.

08

STAGE 08

CONSULTATION FEEDBACK MATRIX

CONSULTATION FEEDBACK MATRIX · COLUMN 1 · STAKEHOLDER CATEGORY THAT RAISED THE ISSUE · COLUMN 2 · ISSUE RAISED, STATED IN THE OBJECTOR'S OWN TERMS · COLUMN 3 · GOVERNMENT RESPONSE, ACCEPTED OR REJECTED, WITH REASONS · COLUMN 4

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
COLUMN 1 → stakeholder category that raised the issue	COLUMN 3 → government response, accepted or rejected, with reasons	COLUMN 5 → unresolved distributional effect that remains after the change
COLUMN 2 → issue raised, stated in the objector's own terms	COLUMN 4 → resulting change to the draft, if any	COLUMN 1 → stakeholder category that raised the issue

CORE CLAIM

- COLUMN 1 → stakeholder category that raised the issue
- COLUMN 2 → issue raised, stated in the objector's own terms

MECHANISM

- COLUMN 3 → government response, accepted or rejected, with reasons
- COLUMN 4 → resulting change to the draft, if any

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- COLUMN 5 → unresolved distributional effect that remains after the change
- COLUMN 1 → stakeholder category that raised the issue

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COLUMN 5 → unresolved distributional effect that remains after the change.

09

STAGE 09

PARTNERSHIP FORMS KEPT DISTINCT

PARTNERSHIP FORMS KEPT DISTINCT · THE STATE BUYS DELIVERY FROM A PROVIDER AGAINST A · SEVERAL PUBLIC AGENCIES ALIGN AT THE POINT OF DELIVERY · CITIZENS PRODUCE THE OUTCOME JOINTLY THROUGH MONITORING AND USER · PUBLIC-PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP · RISK AND FINANCE SHARED UNDER A CONTRACT · SHARED WORK BECOMES NOBODY'S WORK UNLESS ONE DUTY-HOLDER STAYS

CONTRACTING → the state buys delivery from a provider against a specification → CONVERGENCE → several public agencies align at the point of delivery → CO-PRODUCTION → citizens produce the outcome jointly through monitoring and user groups → PUBLIC-PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP → risk and finance shared under a contract → RISK → shared work becomes nobody's work unless one duty-holder stays identifiable

CORE CLAIM

- CONTRACTING → the state buys delivery from a provider against a specification
- CONVERGENCE → several public agencies align at the point of delivery

MECHANISM

- CO-PRODUCTION → citizens produce the outcome jointly through monitoring and user groups
- PUBLIC-PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP → risk and finance shared under a contract

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- RISK → shared work becomes nobody's work unless one duty-holder stays identifiable
- CONTRACTING → the state buys delivery from a provider against a specification

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RISK → shared work becomes nobody's work unless one duty-holder stays identifiable.

10

STAGE 10

WHO IS ABSENT FROM THE FORUM

WHO IS ABSENT FROM THE FORUM · ATTENDANCE, SPEAKING TIME AND PROXY PARTICIPATION ARE THREE DIFFERENT · LANDLESS AND MIGRANT HOUSEHOLDS · OFTEN OUTSIDE THE ELECTORAL ROLL THE FORUM RESTS ON · THE POOREST · BEAR THE HIGHEST RELATIVE WAGE AND TIME COST OF · MINORITIES WITHIN THE VILLAGE · A MAJORITY FORUM CAN DECIDE AGAINST THEM

WOMEN → attendance, speaking time and proxy participation are three different measures → LANDLESS AND MIGRANT HOUSEHOLDS → often outside the electoral roll the forum rests on → THE POOREST → bear the highest relative wage and time cost of attending → MINORITIES WITHIN THE VILLAGE → a majority forum can decide against them → CONSEQUENCE → participation is not a substitute for rights protection

CORE CLAIM

- WOMEN → attendance, speaking time and proxy participation are three different measures
- LANDLESS AND MIGRANT HOUSEHOLDS → often outside the electoral roll the forum rests on

MECHANISM

- THE POOREST → bear the highest relative wage and time cost of attending
- MINORITIES WITHIN THE VILLAGE → a majority forum can decide against them

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CONSEQUENCE → participation is not a substitute for rights protection
- WOMEN → attendance, speaking time and proxy participation are three different measures

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONSEQUENCE → participation is not a substitute for rights protection.

11

STAGE 11

ANSWER SPINE FOR A PARTICIPATION DEMAND

ANSWER SPINE FOR A PARTICIPATION DEMAND · SUBSIDIARITY AS AN INFORMATION AND EXECUTION ARGUMENT, NOT AS · PLACE THE NAMED MECHANISM ON THE LADDER AND ASK · NAME LEGITIMATE CENTRALISATION AND ELITE CAPTURE AS THE TWO · DESIGN CONDITIONS, ABSENT PARTICIPANTS AND A GRADED VERDICT WITH · EVIDENCE LIMIT · USE GRAM SABHAS, WARD COMMITTEES

OPEN → subsidiarity as an information and execution argument, not as a democratic slogan → BUILD → place the named mechanism on the ladder and ask what it can actually → CORRECT → name legitimate centralisation and elite capture as the two counterweights → CLOSE → design conditions, absent participants and a graded verdict with no invented count → EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use Gram Sabhas, ward committees

CORE CLAIM

- OPEN → subsidiarity as an information and execution argument, not as a democratic slogan
- BUILD → place the named mechanism on the ladder and ask what it can actually decide

MECHANISM

- CORRECT → name legitimate centralisation and elite capture as the two counterweights
- CLOSE → design conditions, absent participants and a graded verdict with no invented count

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use Gram Sabhas, ward committees,...
- OPEN → subsidiarity as an information and execution argument, not as a democratic slogan

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → design conditions, absent participants and a graded verdict with no invented count.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · THE 2025 PYQ'S PHRASE "NOT LOCATED CLOSE TO THE" · ELITE CAPTURE IS THE STANDARD COUNTER-ARGUMENT AGAINST AN UNCRITICAL · PARTICIPATORY BUDGETING'S LIMITED INDIAN SCALE (SCATTERED PILOTS, NOT UNIVERSAL · THE PRE-LEGISLATIVE CONSULTATION POLICY (2014) FORMALLY INSTITUTIONALISES CONSULTATION · ITS GOVERNANCE QUALITY DEPENDS ON DISCLOSURE OF A REASONED · MYGOV FUNCTIONS PRIMARILY AS AN IDEAS-CROWDSOURCING AND PUBLIC-CAMPAIGN PLATFORM · PARTICIPATORY-BUDGETING PILOTS IN INDIAN CITIES TYPICALLY ALLOCATE ONLY A

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- CAUTION: The 2025 PYQ's phrase "not located close to the source of information and execution"
- CAUTION: Elite capture is the standard counter-argument against an uncritical "always
- CAUTION: Participatory budgeting's limited Indian scale (scattered pilots, not universal
- The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy (2014) formally institutionalises consultation

ADVANCED DEBATE

- CAUTION: Its governance quality depends on disclosure of a reasoned response/feedback matric
- MyGov functions primarily as an ideas-crowdsourcing and public-campaign platform;
- CAUTION: Participatory-budgeting pilots in Indian cities typically allocate only a modest,
- CAUTION: A centrally designed rural-infrastructure scheme with a standard technical

LEGACY / NUANCE

- CAUTION: Boundary case: a genuinely local, Gram-Sabha-decided micro-infrastructure choice that
- CAUTION: A large-scale, technically complex national infrastructure programme (e.g., a national
- CAUTION: Full subsidiarity-consistent decentralisation requires sustained local capacity
- CAUTION: Co-decision participatory mechanisms (participatory budgeting) are harder to scale

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels